



Sleep & Airway Health

How everyday oral function connects to restful, healthy sleep.

The mouth–airway–sleep connection

Good sleep depends on a clear, open airway. When the tongue rests low, the lips stay open, and breathing shifts to the mouth, the airway can become less stable at night — leading to snoring and fragmented, less restorative sleep. Strengthening and re-posturing the oral muscles is one piece of supporting healthy nighttime breathing.

SIGNS WORTH NOTICING — CHILDREN & ADULTS

- Snoring, gasping, or noisy breathing during sleep
- Restless sleep, frequent waking, or unusual sleep positions
- Teeth grinding or clenching at night
- Morning headaches, dry mouth, or fatigue despite enough hours
- In children: bedwetting, hyperactivity, or trouble focusing

TIP

A calming wind-down

Before bed, practice a few minutes of slow nasal breathing with the lips sealed and tongue on the palate. Quiet, nose-led breathing helps settle the body toward restful sleep.

SUPPORTIVE DAILY HABITS

- Build consistent nasal breathing during the day
- Practice tongue and lip exercises to improve rest posture
- Keep a steady, screen-light sleep routine
- Address nasal congestion so the nose stays clear at night

When to seek an evaluation

Snoring and disrupted sleep are common but not normal. If you or your child show these signs, a myofunctional assessment — together with your physician or a sleep specialist when needed — can help find the cause and the right support.

This guide is for general education only and is not a substitute for individualized medical or dental advice, diagnosis, or treatment. For a personalized assessment, please reach out to Myo Family Health.

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